



The Business
Gym

YOUR PERSONALISED ROADMAP

STAGE 2 - \$1M TO \$2M

Getting Off the *Floor*

Team's stepping up. Systems are starting to work. Now it's time to make it stick - so the business runs whether you're there or not.

200

TONNES/DAY
FACTORY

75

STAFF AT
PREMIER

125

FIVE-STAR
REVIEWS

#1

NZ BEST
WORKPLACE

By **Bernard Powell** - The Business Gym - AME Global Lean Recognition

Stage 2 Diagnosis

Where You Are *The Honest Truth*

You're doing **\$1M–\$2M**. Things are actually working - most days. You've got at least one key person stepping up. Systems are in place. The question is whether this business can run without your hands on the steering wheel.

WHAT THIS FEELS LIKE

You've built something real and you can see it working. But there's a nagging fear underneath the progress - the fear that it all depends on you being there. You book a long weekend and spend the first day checking your phone every 20 minutes. By Tuesday you're fielding calls about problems your team should be solving. The business is getting off the floor, but it hasn't learned to stand on its own yet.

12 MONTHS FROM NOW

If nothing changes, you'll have a bigger business that still can't survive two weeks without you - and you'll be further from the freedom you started this whole thing to get.

46%

of NZ owners at this stage still can't pay themselves a proper wage. Revenue isn't the problem - operational leverage is.

"Revenue is vanity, profit is sanity, and freedom is the prize. You've cracked the first. Now the second. Then the third."

- **Bernard Powell**

What you'll read next Production - SOPs and quality systems. Sales & Pricing - cost-per-unit and quote discipline. Cash Flow - Friday rhythm and forecasting. People - delegation and retention. Systems - documented process ownership. Marketing - referrals and lead consistency. Your Role - shifting from worker to owner.

AREA 1 OF 7

Production

SOPs exist for most jobs. The hardest 20% still needs you.

Your team runs most jobs well enough - but the hard ones still need your eyes. The 20% of processes that separate "good enough" from "great" are still trapped in your head. Your attention is the bottleneck.

\$78,000/yr

Every hour on the floor is an hour NOT on strategy, sales, or hiring. At ~15 hrs/week stuck in production, you're leaking roughly \$78K/yr in strategic value.

The Fix:

1. List the jobs that still need your eyes. Film yourself doing each one.
2. Have your best person shadow you 3 times on each process. Then let them do it while you watch once.
3. Sign off. 90% quality 100% of the time beats 100% only when you're available.

"The last 20% of processes are the hardest to let go of - they're the ones you're proudest of. They're also the ones keeping you trapped."

- Bernard Powell

Bernard's note The first SOP should be ugly. A phone video, a checklist, and one clear quality standard beat another month of explaining the job from scratch. Clean it up later - the real win is getting the process out of your head.

AREA 2 OF 7

Sales & Pricing

Someone else quotes routine jobs. You still handle the big ones.

Routine jobs now go through a team member. But you still handle anything big or complex, and without a proper pricing calculator the team is probably quoting 5–10% under margin on a third of jobs. Under-priced sounds small; over a year it's not.

\$41,600/yr

Eight hours a week on quoting at your time cost = ~\$41,600/yr. Another \$22K–\$45K leaks out on under-priced jobs. Both fix with the same tool.

The Fix:

1. Build a pricing calculator spreadsheet anyone on the team can use. Review margins by product line quarterly.
2. Train your quoting person on the calculator. Let them quote everything under \$50K without you.
3. Raise prices 10–20% on product lines where margins have slipped below target.

"When I built the pricing tool at Premier Group, we found we'd been undercharging on 40% of our product lines. That one spreadsheet added \$200K to annual profit."

- Bernard Powell

Common trap Owners often mistake a fast yes for a good quote. The goal is not to win every job. The goal is to win the right work at the right margin, with a method someone else can repeat.

AREA 3 OF 7

Cash Flow

Tracked weekly. Margins improving. But surprise months still hit.

You track cash weekly now. Margins are improving. But you're still reactive - the month something unexpected hits, you scramble. You're making money, but you can't predict money. Without a forecast, you can't plan hiring, equipment, or growth moves.

Uncapped opportunity cost

Without a 90-day forecast, you can't say yes to the right deals or no to the wrong ones. With zero cash reserves, you don't have a buffer - you have a bomb with a timer.

The Fix:

1. Build a 90-day rolling cash flow forecast. Income by week, expenses by week, running balance. Update it every Friday.
2. Target: pay yourself \$150K-\$250K/yr. Build a 3-month cash reserve. Start with 1 month.
3. Review margin by product line quarterly. Kill or reprice the bottom 10%.

"The 90-day forecast was the first thing I built when Premier hit \$1M. It turned cash flow from a mystery into a tool."

- Bernard Powell

At this stage Cash flow discipline is less about finance jargon and more about facing reality weekly. A simple forecast reviewed every Friday beats a sophisticated spreadsheet you avoid opening.

AREA 4 OF 7

People

You've got a team. But they can't manage themselves yet.

You have a team and at least one key person. But can they manage the others without you? Can they have the hard conversations? If not, you haven't actually delegated - you've just added a messenger. And in NZ's tight labour market, losing anyone at this stage costs big.

\$15K-\$30K per loss

Replacing one employee costs \$15K-\$30K when you factor recruitment, training, lost productivity, mistakes. Retention is cheaper than hiring.

The Fix:

1. Train your key person to run weekly team meetings. Sit in for 2 weeks, then step out.
2. Give them authority to handle performance issues directly. Not just flagging - handling.
3. Run the 3-question retention audit with every person. Act on one answer each within 2 weeks.

"My biggest unlock at Premier Group was when my ops manager started having the hard conversations instead of me. That's the day I stopped being a manager and started being an owner."

- Bernard Powell

Bernard's note Most delegation fails because the standard was never clear enough to inspect. Give people the process, the expected result, and a review point. Then coach the gap instead of taking the job back.

AREA 5 OF 7

Systems

You've started an improvement loop. Does it run without you?

You've got an improvement loop running - maybe 50+ improvements per quarter. But does the system keep running when you go on holiday? If it stops when you stop, it's not a system - it's your hobby. The difference matters.

100+/quarter target

50 per quarter is good. 100 is transformational. The gap is whether the huddle runs when you're not in the room.

The Fix:

1. Hand the daily huddle to your key person. They run Mon–Thu; you observe Friday only.
2. Set a team target: 100+ improvements per quarter WITHOUT you driving it.
3. Test it. Take a week off. Did the huddle happen? Did improvements get logged?

"Lean isn't about big transformations. It's 100 tiny improvements that compound. The 5-minute daily huddle is the single highest-ROI habit I've installed in any factory."

- Bernard Powell

Common trap If a process cannot survive your day off, it is not yet a system. Document the trigger, the steps, and what "done right" looks like. Then test whether someone else can run it without chasing you.

AREA 6 OF 7

Marketing

Referrals are consistent but growth caps out here without a second channel.

You've got consistent lead flow and a referral system. But word-of-mouth alone caps your growth. Every manufacturer who breaks past \$2M has at least two predictable channels. NZ is small - eventually you run out of people who know you.

Growth cap: \$2M

A single channel caps you at this revenue band. Two channels is the baseline for breaking past. Marketing becomes a production line, not a hobby.

The Fix - Pick ONE:

1. **LinkedIn:** one post per week about manufacturing in NZ. Stories, wins, lessons.
2. **Google Ads:** target your key product terms. Start with \$500/month, tune from there.
3. **Email newsletter:** monthly, to past customers. Case studies and updates. Keeps you top-of-mind for the next job.

"At \$1M, marketing stops being optional. The owners who grow past this point treat marketing like a production line - consistent inputs, predictable outputs."

- Bernard Powell

At this stage Referrals work best when you ask right after a win, not when things go quiet. One simple referral question used every month is stronger than a grand marketing plan nobody owns.

AREA 7 OF 7

Your Role

Managing, not doing - most of the time. Can you leave for 2 weeks?

You're managing more than doing. Most days you're off the production floor. But can you leave for two weeks straight without something going wrong? The difference between \$1M and \$3M is whether the owner can step away.

\$1M+ in unrealised growth

Every week you can't step away is a week you can't work ON the business. You're trading strategic growth for the comfort of being needed.

The Fix:

1. Hire or promote an ops manager. If you already have a key person, formalise the role.
2. Define "emergency." Safety incident, loss of top-3 customer, legal issue. Everything else waits.
3. Test it. Leave for two weeks. No calls except real emergencies. Note what broke - that's your next fix list.

"I took my first proper 3-week holiday when Premier hit \$1.5M. The factory ran fine. I cried on the beach - happy tears."

- Bernard Powell

Bernard's note Your highest-value work is choosing priorities, removing blockers, and making better decisions earlier. Every recurring task you keep by habit steals time from the part only the owner can do.

HOW YOU GRADUATE

Moving to *\$2M–\$5M*

You don't need to be perfect. Just these foundations. Achievable within 90 days.

- **Business survived a 1-week absence** - no calls except real emergencies
- **Key person runs team meetings and handles performance** - without you
- **90-day cash flow forecast** updated weekly
- **100+ improvements per quarter** logged by the team, not you
- **At least 1 new marketing channel** running consistently for 90 days

The jump from \$1M–\$2M to \$2M–\$5M is about proving the business works without your hands on the wheel. Every fix above is a direct path there.

Quick check before you move on

- One number you will review every week
- One task someone else now owns
- One process the team can run without asking you

YOUR 90-DAY PLAN

The *10 Actions* That Move You to \$2M–\$5M

You've got the revenue. Now turn it into a business that runs without you.

WEEK 1–2

1. **Film the hardest 20% of processes** – the ones still stuck in your head. Document them.
2. **Build the pricing calculator.** Train your quoting person to use it.
3. **Start the 90-day rolling cash flow forecast.** Update every Friday.

WEEK 3–4

1. **Train your key person to run weekly team meetings.** Sit in for two weeks, then step out.
2. **Run the 3-question retention audit** with every team member. Act on one answer each within two weeks.
3. **Hire a part-time bookkeeper.** Free up 5 hours of your time a week for high-value work.

MONTH 2

1. **Hand the daily huddle to your key person.** You observe Friday only.
2. **Pick and launch one new marketing channel.** LinkedIn, Google Ads, or email.

MONTH 3

1. **Test leaving for one week.** No calls except real emergencies. Track what broke.
2. **Review all 7 areas.** Score yourself honestly – where are the gaps?

90 days from now

You'll have higher prices, tighter cash, a quality system, an empowered team, daily improvements, and real strategy time. That's the jump to \$2M–\$5M.

Priority order Visibility first. Ownership second. Growth third. If you try to grow before the numbers and handoffs are real, you usually just scale the stress.

WHY BERNARD / PBA

You've Read the Roadmap. Now *Don't Do It Alone.*

Reading a roadmap is easy. Actually changing a factory is not. The owners who break through rarely do it alone: they borrow someone else's 30 years of pattern recognition, their own honest mirror, and their refusal to let them slip back into the comfort of being busy.

That's what Bernard Powell brings. He built **Premier Group NZ** from scratch into a **200 tonne-per-day** manufacturer, **#1 NZ Best Workplace**, **AME Global Lean** recognised. Not theory. He lived every stage of your journey.

Then he started coaching. **500+ NZ business owners** have worked with Bernard. No franchise playbook. No borrowed theory. Real advice from someone who spent 30 years on factory floors before he ever coached a single person.

500+OWNERS
COACHED**200**

T/DAY FACTORY

#1NZ BEST
WORKPLACE**AME**

GLOBAL LEAN

125FIVE-STAR
GOOGLE REVIEWS

What Actually *Changes* When You Work With Bernard

1. You stop guessing your numbers.

First session maps true cost per unit and your biggest profit leak. Most owners are underpricing by 10 to 20%. Fixing that alone often pays for the engagement.

2. You build the leverage you've been missing.

Systems, SOPs, delegated ownership. The boring work most coaches skip. This is the work that turns a factory from a trap into a business.

3. You get someone who's made the mistakes.

30+ years on real factory floors. Bernard has seen the 7 ways NZ manufacturers break and the 5 that hit \$5M+. You don't have to guess which path you're on.

4. You don't get a playbook. You get YOUR plan.

Every session is grounded in what you're dealing with this week. Practical. Actionable. Specific to your factory, your staff, your market.

Best fit Best for owners who want blunt feedback and fast implementation. Not a fit if you want vague encouragement while keeping the same bottlenecks.

WHAT OWNERS SAY

Real NZ Owners. *Real Results.*

"Bernard is all go. Full of insights and immediate action. We've been blown away by just how quickly PBA implements and starts bringing positive change. Sometimes the simple things, with the right approach, can be the most effective."

Adrian Day · NZ Manufacturer

"We have had great help from Bernard at PBA shifting mindset and getting stuff done that we would have in all reality just never happened. Thoroughly recommend a strategy session with Bernard."

Patrick Whiteman · NZ Business Owner

"Joining Premier Business Academy was one of the best things we have done in years. With the structure and the way that Bernard and his team are able to teach and train is outrageous. We joined because we wanted to improve the life our business gives us."

Joshua Prestidge · NZ Business Owner

"Bernard is the real deal business coach. Genuine, inspiring and full of energy and ideas. He's walked the walk in business, and already in a short time has helped shift my mindset. I'm seeing a real upward trend in my sales results."

Tim Farland · NZ Business Owner

YOUR NEXT STEP

Stop Guessing. Get a *Straight Talk Session.*

45 minutes. No hard sell. No fluff. An honest conversation about where your factory actually is, what's really holding you back, and the single most important thing you should fix first.

Where will you be in 12 months if nothing changes? **Same place. Same stress. Or worse.**

Book Your Free Straight Talk Session

500+ NZ manufacturers coached · 125 five-star reviews · Free, no obligation



45 minutes



Honest advice



No obligation